

In Python, a *variable* is a name attached to a piece of data. You first define a variable, then use that name when you refer to that piece of data.

In *statically typed languages*, you must declare the kind of data a variable represents when you define it. Python is a *dynamically typed language*, meaning you don't have to declare the kind of data a variable will represent. In Python, the interpreter examines the data associated with the variable throughout the life of the program and manages type issues for you.

Dynamic languages prioritize a programmer's time over efficient use of the processor, but they can still be fast and efficient when used properly. Static languages prioritize processor efficiency over a programmer's time. Programs are longer and more verbose in static languages, but can be highly optimized.